Compare with Other Install Tools

InstallAware	InstallShield
macOS Builds with Apple Notarization	✓
Linux Builds with GTK2 and Qt5	✓
Torrent/Magnet Downloads, P2P Setup Hosting	✓
SOL/ETH Cryptocurrency Payments, Blockchain Records	✓
MSIX Next Generation Package Format	✓
ARM64 Platform (Qualcomm Snapdragon Cellular PC)	✓
APPX Universal Windows Platform (Desktop Bridge)	✓
100% Accurate, Visual, Windows Features Configuration	✓
100% Accurate, Visual, Server Roles Configuration	✓
InstallTailor MST Creation with Transformer	✓
Open Source Desktop Bridge	✓
Advanced Service Configuration	✓
Configure Service Failure Actions	✓
Twitter and Facebook Integration	✓

Stand Alone IDE	✓
Visual Wizards	✓
Setup Capture (Repackaging)	✓
Windows 8.0 Start Screen Force Unpin/Pin	✓
Windows 8.1 Start Screen Force Pin	✓
Windows 10/11 Start Menu Live Tiles Force Unpin/Pin	✓
Visual Studio Integration (2026/2022/2019/17/15/13/12/10/08/05/03)	✓
Windows 7/8.x/10/11 Taskbar Application Pinning	✓
ISO/IEC 19770-2:2009 SWID Tags	✓
Force Shortcut to Run as Administrator	✓
Automatic Windows Certification Compliancy	✓
Dynamic File Linking	✓
Dynamic Features	✓
Scripting	✓
Two-Way Integrated Editing (Visual/Code)	✓
One-Click Patching	✓
Debugger	✓
Service Support	✓
Database Support	✓
Compiler Directives	✓
Manual ICE Validation	✓
Automation Interface	✓
Web Applications	✓
Unlimited Web Updates	✓
Update Client Source Code	✓
Import MSI/MSM Windows Installer Database	✓
Inline Updates	✓
Direct Driverless Setup Capture	✓

Software Bundles and Automatic Web Updates	✓
TFS (2018/17/15/13/12/10)/VSTS/Azure DevOps Services	✓
Automated Virtual Machine Testing	✓
Build Events	✓
Application Runtime Wizard	✓

InstallAware	InstallShield
64-bit Compression	✓
Parallel Build Engine	✓
1.5/2/3/4 GB Compression Dictionaries	✓
30% Faster Single Core Compression Acceleration	✓
Assign Build Affinities	✓
InstantInstall Acceleration	✓
Restart Manager	✓
Command Line Variable Locking	✓
Extra-Long File Paths	✓
Direct Deploy	✓
Native Code Setup Engine	✓
Hybrid Installation Technology	✓
App-V Package Builder	✓
App-V Package Viewer	✓
32 bit & 64 bit Hybrid App-V	✓
App-V MSI Deployment	✓
Try-And-Die DRM for Win32, Win64, .NET	✓
Windows 11 Support	✓
LZMA/BCJ2 Compression	✓
Multi-Core Compression	✓
256 bit AES Encryption	✓

Windows Installer	✓
Merge Modules	✓
Web Media Blocks (Partial Web Deployment/ WebAware Installation)	✓
Interactive Flash Billboards	✓
Interactive HTML Billboards	✓
Maintenance/Repair Installation	✓
Scriptable Uninstallation	✓
Windows 10/8.x Support	✓
One-Click 64-bit Support	✓
DIFx 2.1 Support	✓
Genuine Scripting for Windows Installer (MSIcode Scripting)	✓
Hybrid 32 bit/64 bit Single File Installer	✓
System Tray Minimizable Wizards	✓
Virtual Machine Detection	✓

InstallAware	**InstallShield**
EXE	✓
Plug-Ins	✓
Call Any DLL Function	✓
Unified Scripting (Install/Maintain/Uninstall)	✓

InstallAware	**InstallShield**
Supported Languages	35
Languages Included in Base Package	35
Edit Languages	✓
Redistributable Translation Environment	✓

InstallAware	**InstallShield**

Pre-built Setup Themes	18
Pre-built Runtime Dialogs	313
Dialog Editor	✓
Create New Setup Themes	✓
Available Dialog Controls	44
Automatic Variable Passing to/from Script	✓
Alpha Blending and Transparency	✓
Mica Material, Dark Mode, Acrylic Material, Aero Glass	✓
Fade/Slide Wizard Transition FX	✓

InstallAware	InstallShield
CD / DVD Optical Media	✓
Self Extracting EXE	✓
Light Mode Setups (no setup runtime)	✓
Differential Binary Patching	✓
Partial Web Deployment with Web Media Blocks (WebAware Installation)	✓
Custom Icons in Setup Executables	✓
Release Management (multiple builds)	✓
Command Line Build Tools	✓
Azure Trusted Signing	✓
Future-Proof Code Signing Hooks	✓
SHA 256 Authenticode Code Signing, EV Certificates	✓
Redistributable Build Interface	✓
Web Based Automation Interface	✓

InstallAware	InstallShield
XP/2003/Vista/2008/7/2008 R2/8/2012/8.1/2012 R2/10/2016/2019/2022/11/2025	✓
.NET Framework	✓

Internet Information Services	✓
Microsoft SQL Server	✓
My SQL	✓
Oracle, Oracle Net	✓
Pre-install MSI runtime including x64 Editions	✓
Pre-install .NET Framework x64 Editions	✓
Pre-install of .NET Framework 1.1 with Service Pack 1	✓
Pre-install of .NET Framework 2.0 with Service Pack 2	✓
Pre-install of .NET Framework 3.0 with Service Pack 2	✓
Pre-install of .NET Framework 3.5 with Service Pack 1	✓
Pre-install of .NET Framework 4.0, 4.5.2, 4.6.2, 4.7.2, 4.8.1	✓
Pre-install of .NET 5.0.17, 6.0.36, 7.0.20, 8.0.22, 9.0.11, 10.0.0	✓
Pre-install Internet Explorer 6	✓
Pre-install Internet Explorer 7	✓
Pre-install Internet Explorer 8	✓
Pre-install Internet Explorer 9	✓
Pre-install Internet Explorer 10	✓
Pre-install Internet Explorer 11	✓
Pre-install Java Virtual Machine	✓
Pre-install Microsoft SQL Server Express 2025	✓

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